



Job well done: Trent

Alexander-Arnold and Virgil van Dijk played crucial roles this campaign.

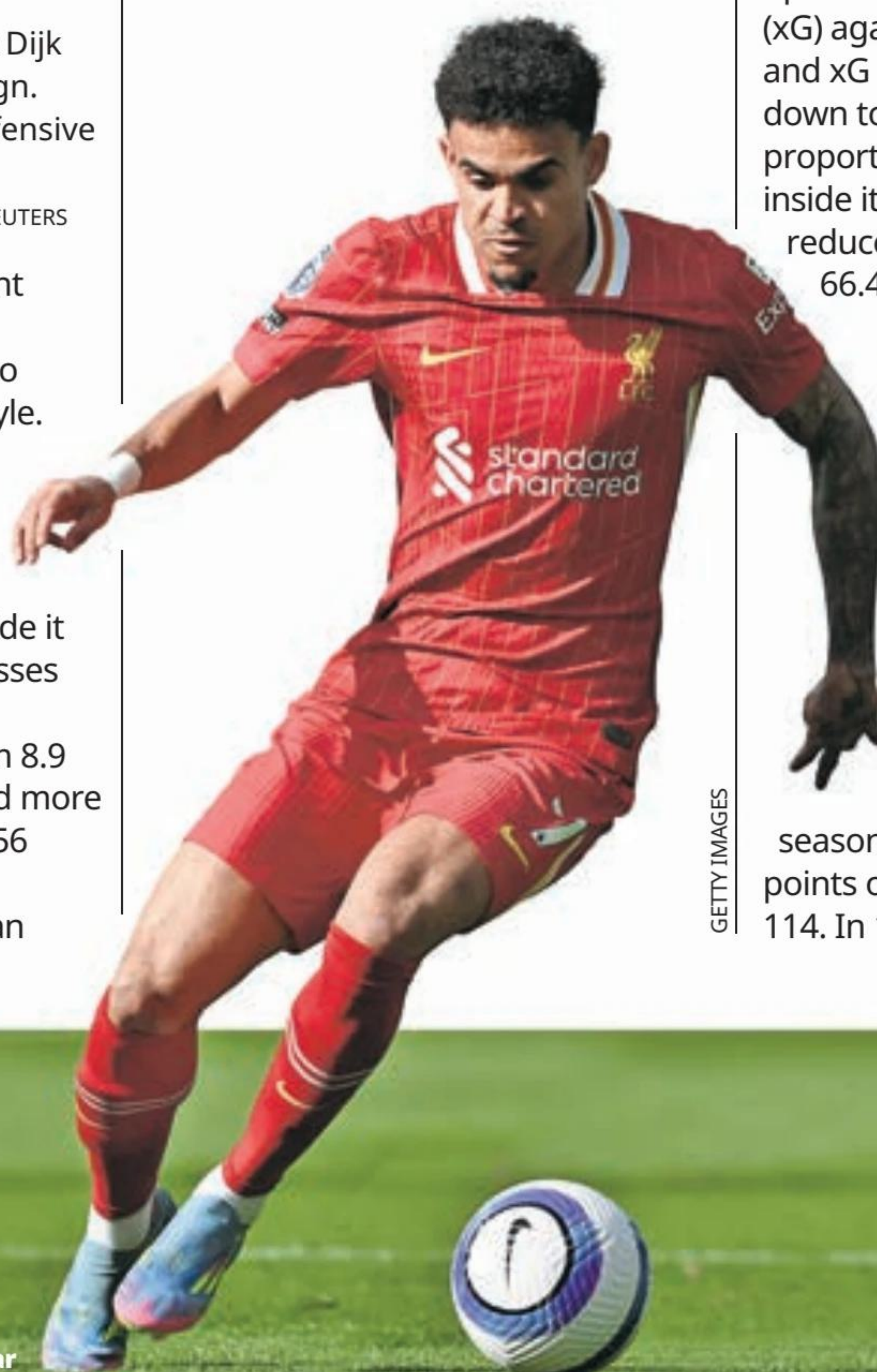
Above right: To address the defensive midfield issue, Slot moved Ryan Gravenberch to the No. 6 role. REUTERS

allowing Liverpool's feared front three to do the damage.

Slot didn't come in looking to dismantle Klopp's ingrained style. Instead, he made a few adjustments to refine the existing system.

Slot's Liverpool wasn't the aggressive counter-pressing side it was under Klopp. Its PPDA (passes allowed per defensive action) dropped to 10.2 (4th best) from 8.9 (2nd) last season. But it exerted more pressures per game, up to 12.56 (5th) from 10.31 (3rd).

The defensive metrics saw an



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uptick as well, with expected goals (xG) against it dropping to 0.85 (1st), and xG allowed per shot coming down to 0.09 (1st) this season. The proportion of shots allowed from inside its own penalty box has reduced to 61.18% (1st), from 66.4% (8th) last year.

Slot's men blew away teams at Anfield with the trio of Salah, Luis Diaz (left) and Cody Gakpo running riot.

While Liverpool had always boasted a strong record at home under Klopp, Slot was tasked with fixing the club's wavering away form to make it a credible title challenger. In the previous two seasons, the Reds claimed just 57 points on the road out of a possible 114. In 16 away matches this season,